Examiners' Report
Summer 2026

GCSE History 1HI0 31

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Introduction

Most candidates seemed to find the paper accessible as there were few blank answers. Candidates also seemed confident in tackling the various question styles. A full range of responses suggests this paper was accessible to candidates of all ability and full answers were generally provided, showing that timing wasn't generally an issue on this paper.

The answer spaces provided are intended to be sufficient for the question to be answered in full and although some candidates did write on extra sheets, they were not always as successful as those who produced more concise answers. Where additional space is needed, it is important that candidates clearly state the answer is continued elsewhere and that this is done on paper, and not in the answer space for another question.

Questions on this paper cover all the Assessment Objectives but over half of the available marks are for question 3, which focuses on sources and interpretations. These questions form a coherent package leading to a final question in which candidates, having explored the utility of the provided sources, analysed the different views presented in the interpretations and suggested reasons for those differences, are then invited to judge the extent to which they agree with Interpretation 2.

It is important that candidates appreciate the difference between sources and interpretations, and the focus of the different parts of question 3. There are still a number of candidates who do not understand the difference between question 3(b) and question 3(c). In question 3b, candidates should identify the difference between the views offered in the two interpretations and support this with details from each interpretation. Most candidates found this straightforward and many scored the full 4 marks. However, when they are asked to suggest a reason for the difference in views in question 3(c), candidates should remember that the authors have constructed these interpretations and chosen to present them in this specific way.

The most common explanation for the difference was that the authors had chosen to place weight on different sources but it is important to support this with details from the interpretations and the sources in order to meet the mark scheme requirement that 'An explanation of a reason for difference is given, **analysing the interpretations**. The explanation is **substantiated effectively'**. This support does not need to be detailed but many answers failed to score full marks because they included only quotations from, or references to, the sources or the interpretations but not both. It should also be noted that it is not possible to provide effectively substantiated reasons why the interpretations are different, based on such things as where and when the interpretations were published, or the nature of the original, for example a website or a textbook.

The focus of question 3(d) is on the interpretations and candidates who provide their own view of the issue in the question are unlikely to access the higher levels of the mark scheme. Similarly, every level of the mark scheme above Level 1 refers to 'interpretations'. There is no expectation that both interpretations are dealt with in equal depth, but both should be examined explicitly. Answers which only analyse one interpretation can score above Level 1 if they perform well in other strands of the mark scheme but they will not meet all the demands of the mark scheme in the higher Levels.

The use of contextual knowledge is an important element in this evaluation, being one strand of the mark scheme at every Level. However, it must be selected to support the evaluation of the interpretations and not just used to display knowledge of the topic. Many answers provided large sections of contextual knowledge without any reference to the interpretations. Candidates should aim to link every piece of contextual knowledge to a point being made about the interpretations. They may also use the content of the sources as contextual knowledge, when evaluating the interpretations.

By question 3(d), candidates will have thought about the difference between the interpretations and should have recognised that both these alternative interpretations can be valid. A feature of strong answers in 3(d) is to show an understanding that the authors have constructed their interpretations to present their conclusions. This does not mean that the interpretations should be evaluated as sources or evaluated as ‘biased’ but this should lead to a recognition of how the authors have conveyed their different views; this could include their use of language, the tone of their writing, their choice of details to include or omit, their decision of how to present their material, their choice of emphasis etc. Answers just need to show an understanding that the author has chosen what language to use or what to emphasise; they do not need to judge how effective this. This element of their argument is even more effective if it is integrated into the answer rather than left as a stand-alone comment. Incorporating this understanding can be seen in comments such as: ‘the author presents this as a positive aspect’, ‘the interpretation focuses on … and omits …’, ‘the language is very critical’ or ‘only including this at the end, plays down its significance’.

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GCSE History specification and assessment changes

This note is a reminder that minor changes have been made to the Pearson Edexcel GCSE History specification content and assessment model: assessment and language changes apply from the June 2025 exam series onwards, and content changes from the June 2026 exam series onwards.

We strongly recommend, if you haven't already, that you familiarise yourself with these changes in time for the start of the new academic year in September 2026. Some options are affected more than others, but all options are affected by the assessment changes.

Below is a link to the summary guidance document, which will help you to find all the specific information and guidance available to help you take on board these changes:

https://qualifications.pearson.com/content/dam/pdf/GCSE/History/2016/Teaching-and-learning-materials/gcse-history-changes-for-2025-and-2026-summary-guidance.pdf

If you have any queries, please contact Mark Battye, our History subject advisor, at TeachingHistory@pearson.com.

Question 1

This question requires candidates to make two inferences from a source and it is sometimes regarded as an ‘easy’ question. However, candidates need to be sure that the inferences they make from the source are not based on their own knowledge as this question assesses AO3 (analyse, evaluate and use sources) and no marks are available for AO1 (knowledge and understanding). Candidates also need to ensure that the inferences they make relate to the enquiry in the question; in this case, the enquiry was about how the Nazis dealt with opposition but sometimes the inferences, although valid inferences, had little relation to the enquiry.

The source was an extract from a speech by Pastor Niemöller in 1946 (he made several versions of this speech). The most common inferences were that the Nazis dealt with the various groups separately, that they prioritised the communists who were political opponents, and that they created a climate of fear, which prevented other people from protecting these groups. However, the emphasis in the question is on the actions of the Nazis, not the reaction or emotion of the public.

Details from the source can only be rewarded if they are provided as support for an inference; marks cannot be awarded If a valid inference has not been made or if the detail from the source does not support the inference in the answer. No marks are available for candidates who provided simple paraphrases, description, or comprehension of the source.

1 Give **two** things you can infer from Source A about how the Nazi Party dealt with opposition in the years 1933–39.

Complete the table below to explain your answer.

(i) What I can infer:

Nazi's removed opposition one by one

Details in the source that tell me this:

" Nazi's came for the comunist ... Then They came for the trade unionists"

(ii) What I can infer:

Nazi's instilled fear so people wouldn't risea against percecussion

Details in the source that tell me this:

" I did not speak out."

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Examiner Comments

Two valid inferences are made here: that the Nazis targeted each group separately and that they created a climate of fear so that no-one would interfere. Each inference is supported by details from the source. It received the full 4 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Each inference must be supported by a detail from the source.

1 Give **two** things you can infer from Source A about how the Nazi Party dealt with opposition in the years 1933–39.

Complete the table below to explain your answer.

(i) What I can infer:

The Nazi party came for all of them but came for them Separately communists , unionists , Jews and finally the pastor himself

Details in the source that tell me this:

pastor Niemöller [redacted] tells us who they took and in order telling us the pastor was taken last.

(ii) What I can infer:

The [redacted] pastor was Scared at the end of his Speech

Details in the source that tell me this:

“there was no one left to speak for me”

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

The first answer is a valid inference about what the Nazis did to deal with opposition. However, the second inference, although it is a valid inference about Niemöller's feelings, is not about how the Nazis dealt with opposition. This answer received 2 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Check the question to make sure the inferences you have made are relevant to the question – in this case, how the Nazi Party dealt with opposition.

Question 2(a)

In question 2, the focus will always be on causation but the question does not require a judgement to be made or for the answer to prioritise or show interaction of factors and no marks are available to reward such evaluation, however strongly argued. Instead, the most successful candidates showed a consistent analytical focus throughout their answers and a pleasing number of candidates were able to access Level 4 by doing so.

The stimulus points in the question will often be useful reminders to candidates of content they may wish to include. There is no requirement to use them but at the higher levels, there is an expectation that there will be some breadth of knowledge, shown by three discrete aspects of content being covered, although this does not mean candidates need to identify three different causes, factors or events.

Question 2a, was about why there were changes in the position of women in society. This covered a wide timescale, allowing candidates to discuss Weimar and/or Nazi Germany. In both options, a number of answers remained at Level 3, despite excellent knowledge, because they missed the focus of the question. Such answers to question 2a described the situation of women, either in Weimar of Nazi Germany but did not focus on why change occurred. For examples, candidates often showed excellent knowledge of the marriage loan and Motherhood Cross but did not explain why these led to changes in the position of women or why Hitler introduced them.

Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☐

Write your answer here: One reason why there were changes in the position of woman in society in the years 1924-1939 was due to the Weimar Republic's view on women. In Weimar Germany, (1924-1929) women were allowed to vote if over the age of 20, which was more accomplished than most other countries at the time. Also, the Weimar Republic gave women equal rights to men, allowing them to own property etc. Due to this, lots of women left the traditional ~~jobs~~ role placed upon them and went to work instead, prioritising fun over marriage and children. This explains why women's position in society changed because the Weimar Republic's laws and views on the female society allowed women to have more freedom and escape the traditional mold of wife and child-bearer. As a result, lots of women ~~adapted~~ changed their roles in the Germany society.

Another reason why there were changes in the position of women in society from 1924-39 was due to the Nazi policies on women and their role in the family. In Nazi Germany, women were meant to be loyal wives who gave birth to and cared for Aryan children. It subverted the role that the Weimar Government had placed. Women were encouraged to have lots of children, even getting medals on 12th August each year for the number of kids the woman had. (4 was a bronze medal, 6 was silver and 8 was gold). Also, the Nazi's encouraged women to be married, issuing out marriage loans under The Marriage Law, as a way to convince women to get married. This explains why there was a change because the Nazi subverted the role of women to once again be traditional. Due to the rewards for many women if they complied, more females changed to suit the traditional role of the Nazi women (kitchen, Children, Church), resulting in a change in society.

Finally, another reason why there were changes in the position of women in society was due to Nazi restrictions on the gender. The Nazi's, once in power, tried to push women out of their jobs to force them to submit to the idealised traditional role. ~~women~~ Eventually, the only job women could get was being a factory worker. Also, women were encouraged not to get jobs and to not go to university, soon banning them from attending, restricting women in Nazi Germany even more. Women were no longer allowed to be doctors or lawyers and this was extended to most jobs by 1939. This explains why there was change because the restrictions the Nazi's placed on women, mainly resulted in women turning to the traditional route and submitting to the standards. The women changed from their free lifestyle due to the pressure and lack of other options imposed by the Nazi's.

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Examiner Comments

The answer covers three separate aspects of content – increased freedom and independence in Weimar Germany, the Nazi emphasis on marriage and motherhood, and opportunities in education and employment. Both analysis and knowledge are Level 4 and this answer received the full 12 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Make sure that every section of your answer focuses on the specific enquiry in the question.

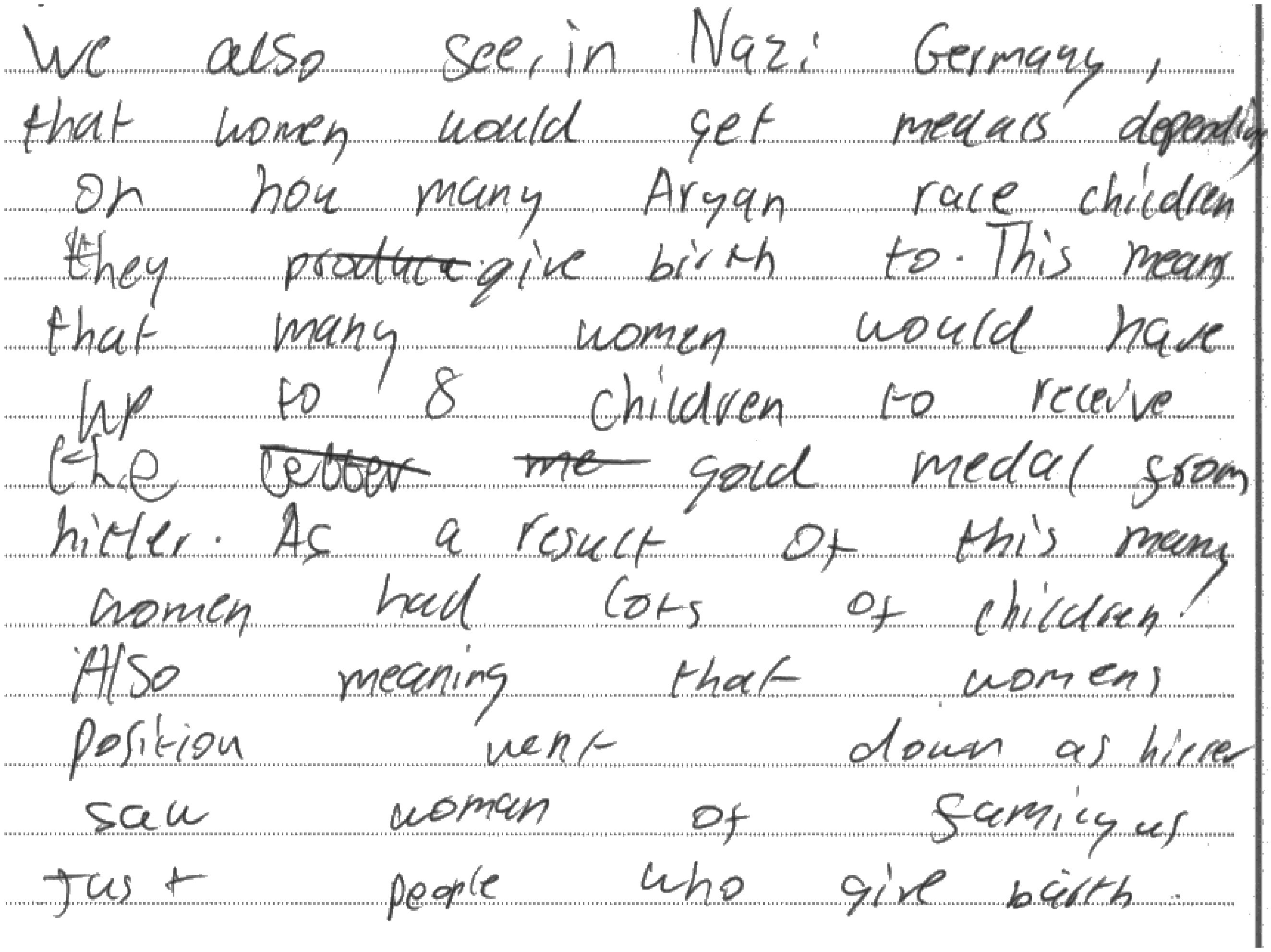
Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☒

Point in t,
Evidence
This means
As a result

Write your answer here:

We see in Weimar Germany Women are able to have Jobs. women could work in shops and other types of Jobs. This means that womens position in society was quiet respected. As a result of this women had lots of freedom in weimar Germany.

We then see in Nazi Germany changes in position. Due to Nazi policies on family. Nazi policies on family was that women could not work and had to stay at home and look after their children. This means that women ~~had~~ were not able to work in Nazi Germany. As a result of that meaning the positon of women in society lower.



We also see, in Nazi Germany, that women would get medals depending on how many Aryan race children they ~~produce~~ give birth to. This means that many women would have up to 8 children to receive the ~~better~~ ~~me~~ gold medal from hitler. As a result of this many women had lots of children. Also meaning that womens position went down as hitler saw woman of family as just people who give birth.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

The answer makes valid points about women having more independence in Weimar Germany and their position changing in Nazi Germany but the explanation is often generalised. The final section has some specific detail describing the Motherhood Cross system but not focusing on why this policy was brought in and why it led to change. This answer was placed at the top of Level 2 and received 6 marks.

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Examiner Tip

Make sure each point is explained (not just stated) and try to include precise details to support each point of analysis.

Question 2(b)

In question 2b, a number of candidates either did not read the question properly or had a shaky grasp of chronology because they included events after Hitler became Chancellor, for example, the Reichstag Fire, the Enabling Act, or the death of Hindenburg.

The focus needed to be on events leading up to Hitler becoming Chancellor. Many answers had excellent knowledge of the political campaigning and election results in the years 1930–32, of the political manoeuvring by individuals such as von Papen in persuading Hindenburg to appoint Hitler, or the effects of the Depression, causing many Germans to lose faith in the moderate parties. Some answers went back to Hitler's re-founding of the Nazi Party and considered the Nazi Party's attempts to appear as a legitimate party and to adopt legal methods to gain power, which was also a valid line of discussion. However, some answers confused the Depression with hyperinflation and thought the Munich Putsch took place at the end of the 1920s.

It is understandable that events and chronology become confused but it was disappointing to see excellent knowledge being offered when no reward was possible. Many answers were pegged at mid-Level 3 because they did not have three valid aspects of content.

Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☒

Write your answer here:

Hitler became chancellor in 1933 due to people ~~to~~ began looking for more extream ways for the contry to be ran. This is due to the great depression that was in ~~in~~ 1929 which ruined ~~of~~ the German economy and made many people loose their savings. This made people turn towards extreemist ~~part~~ parties such as the Nazis to ran the contry. Hitler used this so that he would be able to convince people to vote him in to give him power. This links back to the question because it states why Hitler began to appeal more to the people which he would of needed so that he would be able to become chancellor.

Another reason why hitler became chancellor in 1933 was because of the elections in 1932. In these elections the Nazi party got a high percentage of the votes and gained many seats in the Riestag. This would mean that the Nazi party is a both big ~~party~~ Party but is ~~other~~ also heavily supported by a large percentage of the contry. This is important as the chancellor in Germany is often a member of one of the larger parties during an election and is picked by the president at that time. This would ~~link~~ link back to the question because it is showing how this is a way that Hitler became the chancellor in germany in 1933.

A third reason why hitler became chancellor in 1933 is because he was able to convince president Hindemburg ~~about~~ to give him the role of chancellor in the Rishstag. Hindenburg did not originally want to give hitler the role of chancellor as he didn't trust him. He offered him the role of vice chancellor but hitler did not accept it. Hitler managed to convince Hidenburg to make him chancellor by speaking to van papin and telling him to convince Hindenburg. Then in 1933 Hindenburg made Hitler chancellor. This is linking to the question as it is one of the reasons that Hitler was given the role of chancellor.

A fourth reason in which hitler was made chancellor in 1933 was because of how he convinced the people to vote for him. Hitler often did speaches where he appealed to the working classes promising higher pay and better working conditions. He visited many cities a day by ~~flo~~ flying ~~by~~ plane.

This made Hitler gather a larger group of people who supported him and wanted ~~his~~ to vote for ~~him~~ the Nazi party to be in control of Germany. This Links to the question as it is shown here by Hitler gathering a larger group to support his party the chances that he becomes ~~Hitler~~ ~~a~~ chancellor increase which shown by his success in 1933 when he became chancellor.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

The answer shows good understanding of various reasons why popular support for Hitler increased and Hindenburg became willing to offer Hitler the position of Chancellor. It has a clear focus on the question and was awarded 12 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Remember to keep focused on the question and explain specific reasons for change.

Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☒

Write your answer here: Explain why Hitler became Chancellor in 1933?

Starting off with the ~~&~~ Great Depression was when there was a major unemployment and poverty in Germany. Many ~~to~~ people stopped believing in the government and turned to extremist parties such as the Nazis, who said they would help them.

The Weimar republic was weak so ~~this~~ it made it difficult to deal with economic and political crises. Governments changed, creating the impression that democracy was ineffetive.

~~Hitlers~~

Hitlers speaking skills helped him gain a lot of support. He was a powerful speaker who appealed to different groups by promising them jobs so now he had more support.

The Nazi propaganda was also one of the reasons why Hitler became Chacellor. The Nazis used posters, newspapers, radios and so on to spread their message to the world and increase their support.

Also people feared communism this encouraged wealthy business owners and other important people to support Hitler. Many believed that the Nazis could stop a communist Revolution.

The Nazi party at this stage had a lot of supporters and Hitler was their Political leader. the Nazi had become the biggest party in the Reichstag.

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Examiner Comments

The answer shows some understanding of the various reasons why Hitler became Chancellor but the explanations lack supporting details. It received 7 marks.

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Examiner Tip

Make sure that each point being made is supported by factual detail before you move on to the next point.

Question 3(a)

Question 3(a) targets the ability to analyse and evaluate source utility and, in doing so, introduces the enquiry which will be dealt with in further detail in questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

In question 3(a) candidates are expected to evaluate the usefulness of the content of the sources, taking account of the provenance of the sources and applying contextual knowledge in making judgements about the utility of the sources as evidence for the specific enquiry. In this case, the enquiry focused on the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923. These strands in the mark scheme are linked and should be dealt with together in the answer, rather than in isolation, as part of a check-list approach.

Answers suggested that candidates found the sources accessible, and they were confident in showing that the content of the sources was relevant for the enquiry and therefore useful. The best answers were explicit about how the information could be used by the historian, each source showing a different aspect of problems faced by the Weimar Republic.

Answers usually start with the content of the sources, showing that they contain useful information or insights. However, it is not necessary to make several points about the source content as the key to this question is that the source's provenance or the candidate's contextual knowledge may strengthen or weaken the value of this content.

When considering provenance, candidates should try to avoid generic comments about a source being biased (with no explanation of how that bias appears in the source or why it occurred) or about the source being reliable because it came from the time under investigation. Such comments could be made without any reference to the individual source and therefore remained at Level 1. Candidates should read the attribution of the sources carefully. Many candidates use the acronym NOP (Nature, Origin, Purpose) when discussing provenance but it should be remembered that they only need to discuss one of these aspects and they should think carefully about which is the most relevant. For example, many answers about Source C noted that it came from Hitler's speech in the Munich beer hall but they then failed to develop this, for example by considering his audience or his purpose. Some answers declared the speech was biased but did not explain this assertion and a frequent comment about both sources was that they must be reliable since they dated from 1923. There was also some confusion as some candidates did not understand that the Weimar Republic and Germany were the same country.

Unfortunately, some very good answers could not access the higher marks because they did not include contextual knowledge. Contextual knowledge is mentioned at every level of the mark scheme and failure to include it limited a number of otherwise good answers. Candidates should recognise that it is not enough to repeat a detail from the source and assert that this can be confirmed from the candidate's own knowledge, or to give generalised comments such as 'I know that paper money was worthless' – some additional detail is needed as a demonstration of that own knowledge.

Yet additional information should not be added as a stand-alone point. Contextual knowledge should be relevant to the enquiry and used to assess the source, for example, to confirm or challenge something mentioned in the source, to add weight to an aspect of the provenance, to place the source in a broader context, or to assess whether the source gave an accurate view or showed a typical situation. Examiners felt that more candidates than previously made an effort to include contextual knowledge but that it was not always used in the evaluation of the source.

This question is the one where additional paper was used most often. However, many lengthy answers made a number of points about content and/or provenance yet remained at Level 2, while an answer making one point about content, one about provenance and using contextual knowledge, has the potential to reach Level 3. Some answers used a checklist approach, offering brief, separate statements about content, provenance and contextual knowledge but not linking them into an evaluation of the source. Candidates should consider the effect of an aspect of the provenance on the usefulness of the source content, and integrate contextual knowledge in the process of reaching a judgement.

Sources should not be dismissed because they do not cover every detail that might be helpful in an investigation and the focus should be on assessing the usefulness of what is in the source rather than listing details which are not mentioned. It can be valid to note the limitations of a source if this leads to a distorted impression or if the limitations are linked to a consideration of the provenance, for example, whether the limitation is the result of the author's lack of knowledge or a deliberate omission. However, these points need to be used in an overall evaluation of the usefulness of the source. It is unrealistic to expect a source to cover all aspects of an event and an answer which focuses on 'missing' information without weighing the positive aspects of the source, is unlikely to score highly.

Good answers made clear the criteria being used to assess the usefulness of the sources for the enquiry, weighing the insight provided by the content in the light of the provenance and the candidate's own knowledge. Various criteria could be used, for example accuracy of detail, reliability, the relevance of the source, the way it could be used by the historian, how representative the source is etc.

There is no requirement to compare the sources or to use them in combination and no marks are available for this. Candidates who focused on comparisons between the sources often failed to develop their judgement on each source properly.

Very few answers only considered one source but it should be noted that every level of the mark scheme refers to 'sources' and therefore answers which do not consider both sources cannot access high marks. There are also no marks for candidates' own views of the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923.

3 (a) **Study Sources B and C.**

How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923?

Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context.

(8)

Source B is quite useful for an enquiry into the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923 as it explores the consequences of ~~the~~ hyperinflation which was arguably ~~to~~ the biggest problem the Weimar Republic was facing in 1923. The source ~~shows~~ is a photograph showing businessmen loading baskets of banknotes onto a vehicle during the crisis. ~~This provenance~~ This can be strengthened as I know hyperinflation meant that money became worthless as the Weimar ~~Republic~~ government printed ~~too~~ too much money in attempt to pay ~~A~~ striking Ruhr workers and pay off ~~&~~ the pending reparations in 1923. This meant [illegible] people couldn't afford basic necessities ~~or~~ such as bread which increased from 1 mark in 1919 to 200,000 million marks in 1923 due to money being worthless. This was a problem as it meant ~~Weimar Republic was in chaos and~~ [illegible] Germany was in chaos and the Weimar Republic was struggling to control it.

The provenance of this source strengthens it ~~at~~ as it is a snapshot in time which is unlikely to be staged as it would put the Weimar Republic in a negative light. Overall, source B is ~~a~~ useful for an enquiry into the problems faced as ~~the~~ hyperinflation affected many.

However, source ~~A~~ C is less useful for an enquiry into the problems faced as portrays the ~~Mu~~ Munich Putsch as a major problem. Source C is a speech from Hitler, which decreases it's usefulness as ~~H~~ Hitler ~~a~~ was a charismatic, powerful speaker who spoke in a way to convince people of his views and attract them, hence his ~~views~~ saying on the Munich Putsch would have been ~~the~~ a way to portray the Nazi party as powerful. In source C it says, "The government of the Weimar Republic, led by the November criminals, has been overthrown." ~~The~~ This weakens it's usefulness as I know that ~~the~~ information of the putsch had been ~~g~~ passed to Ebert who quickly dealt with it and had police waiting in Munich, Berlin to arrest the Nazi's. However, Hitler fled while some Nazi's were killed, but only 2 days later Hitler was caught and arrested. As a result the Nazi party was banned. So overall, source C is not useful for problems faced by the Weimar Republic as it was not a threat or major issue and was very quickly and calmly dealt with.

In conclusion, source B is useful for an enquiry into the problems faced as hyperinflation was a major threat to Weimar Republic and Germany in comparison to ~~the~~ the Munich Putsch which was dealt with immediately.

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Examiner Comments

The answer shows the usefulness of the content of the sources but also takes into account their provenance and uses contextual knowledge in the evaluation. The answer explains that the provenance of B strengthens the evidence of the photograph, giving a valid explanation of why the photograph was unlikely to be staged. The integration of contextual knowledge with an assessment of the source content's utility can be seen when it explains that the Munich Putsch was quickly dealt with. The answer covers all 3 strands of the mark scheme for each source and therefore it received the full 8 marks.

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Examiner Tip

Think carefully about which aspect of the provenance is significant - the source's nature, origin or purpose. You do not have to cover all of them but you should show the effect on the content of whichever aspect is most relevant. For example, is it a private letter or diary, or is it intended to be published, does a photograph help you to understand the scale of an event, is the date when was it produced significant or does the author have good knowledge of the situation, who is it intended for and what effect is it intended to have?

3 (a) **Study Sources B and C.**

How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923?

Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context.

(8)

Sources B and C are [illegible] quite useful for telling us some of the problems that the Weimar republic faced this is due to both sources telling and showing us two different issues that they had to deal with in 1923.

Source D is useful due to being photographic evidence of the hyperinflation crisis and the problems it caused for the country and specifically the banks of the country. It shows a man with baskets filled with bank notes trying to drop them off at the bank. This shows how much money it took to buy [illegible] items during the hyperinflation crisis so that bussinessmen had thousands of banknotes in baskets so therefore source B is useful.

Source C is useful because it shows how threatening the ~~Ag~~ Nazi party was to the weimar republic at this time, with them taking over army bases and even police bases. This tells us that the Nazi party were causing serious damage to the weimar republic ~~[illegible]~~ and that they were constantly putting pressure on them which contributed to their failure as leaders of the government so therefore Source C is ~~of~~ very useful since it shows us points that weakend the weimar republic.

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Examiner Comments

The answer includes some good comments about the content of each source but there is little consideration of provenance and there is no contextual knowledge included, so this cannot move beyond mid-Level 2, 4 marks.

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Examiner Tip

The answer should cover all three strands in the mark scheme: a discussion of the usefulness of the source content, linked to a consideration of how an aspect of the provenance affects that value, and using contextual knowledge to confirm or challenge the source content or to evaluate the significance of an aspect of provenance.

Question 3(b)c

In question 3(b), candidates are asked to identify a difference in the overall views being offered in the interpretations. These do not necessarily contradict each other but they do provide alternative views. The answers should identify the key difference rather than minor differences in detail but should also provide support from each interpretation to demonstrate that difference.

Many answers recognised that the two interpretations offered different views about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic and could select detail from the two interpretations to support the explanation of that difference. Answers identified a focus on the economic problems of hyperinflation and alternatively, the political issues of challenges to the government.

However, some answers simply selected details from the interpretations and presented them without explanation, or described the views of each interpretation in turn, without explaining how this demonstrated the difference in the overall views. These answers remained in Level 1, as did responses which asserted differences without providing support.

Level 2 was achieved when the candidates indicted a clear difference of view and supported it with detail from the extracts. It was pleasing to see that many candidates were able to score full marks with relatively short answers.

It is important that candidates recognise the relationship between questions 3(b) and 3(c). Having recognised that the two interpretations offer different views, candidates are asked to suggest a reason why the authors have reached different conclusions about the focus of the enquiry. They should be able to support their answer with reference to the interpretations but they should also make sure that their answer to 3(c) does not simply repeat their answer to 3(b). The best answers have a clear understanding that the interpretations are the result of decisions made by the authors.

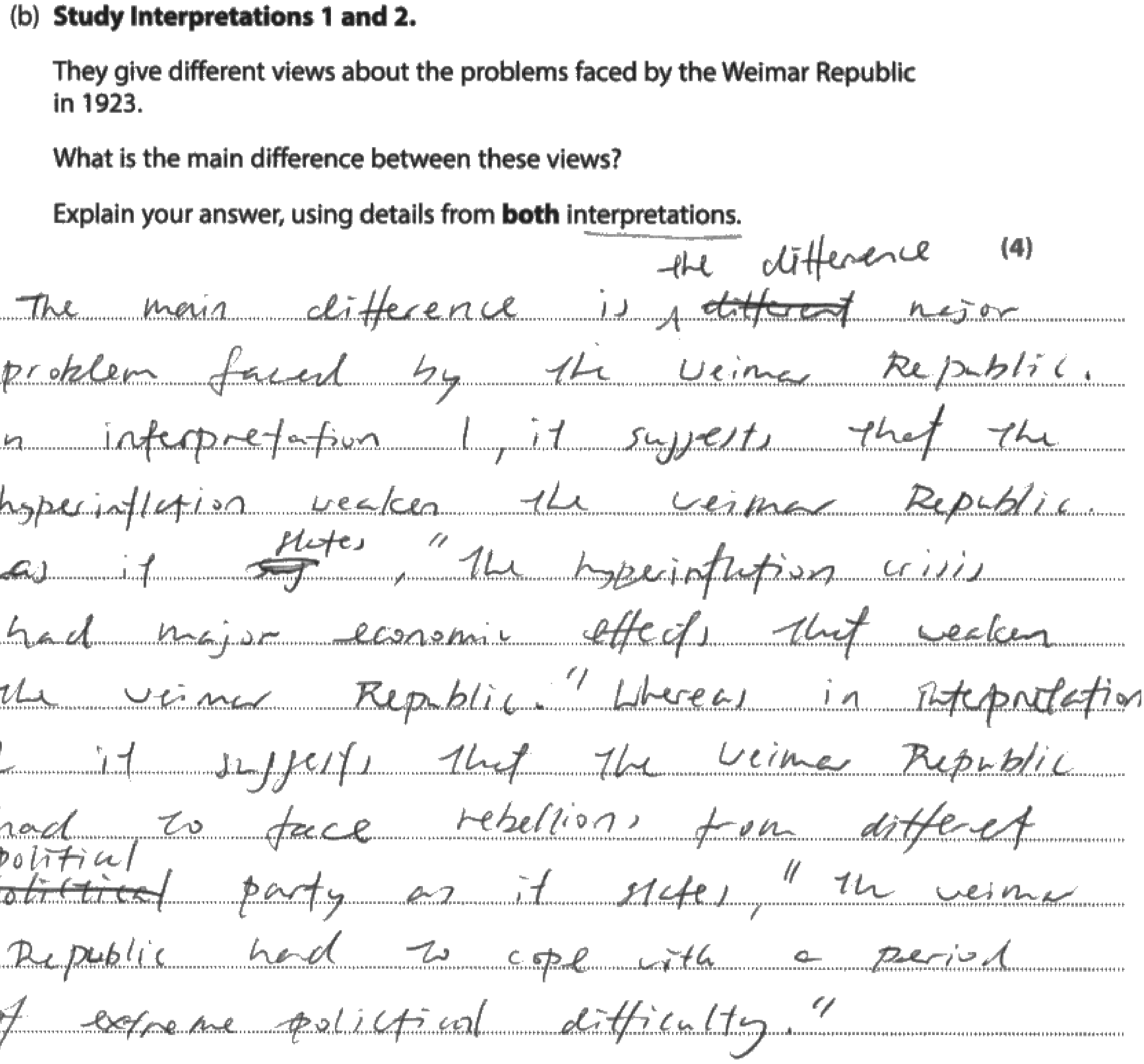
Examiners commented that candidates have become more confident in answering this question, particularly those who understand that historians use sources as the building blocks to form views and interpretations. Where answers suggested that when carrying out research, the authors had placed weight on different sources, candidates could easily score the full 4 marks by linking details in the interpretations with details in Sources B and C. However, this should be explained with details from both the interpretations and both the sources, rather than simply stating that 'the author of Interpretation 1 might have used Source B' or 'interpretation 2 and Source C 'both look at the political problems'. They should also try to avoid statements such as 'Interpretation 2 supports Source C' as this suggests they have not understood the relationship between the sources and the interpretations. The question is about the interpretations as the end-product of the research process and Level 2 of the mark scheme refers to answers analysing the interpretations and substantiating their explanation.

Alternative explanations should also recognise that the historian's approach may affect his research and conclusions, for example, whether an historian focuses on economic problems or political ones. Here again, the explanation needs to be supported by the use of the interpretations showing how the authors' choice of focus led them to offer different views, not simply stating that the authors had different approaches or that they emphasised different aspects of the situation in 1923.

Speculation that the difference between the interpretations is a result of an aspect of their provenance, for example the date that the interpretations were produced, is not valid as it cannot be supported with explicit details. The full reasons for this are explained in the *Getting Started Guide* on pp 43–44. There is also some additional guidance in the 2019 Examiners' Report on p.25. As stated in *Getting Started*: 'Candidates should distinguish between their comments on contemporary sources and on these texts. Responses based on matters such as the origin or time of production of these secondary works are unlikely to be valid for this question.'

While it is very pleasing to note that fewer candidates than previously, tried to provide an explanation of the difference on the basis of such factors as the titles of the books, their origin or date of production, there was still a small number of candidates who gained no marks on this question as they merely repeated what had been said in question 3b, asserted that the authors were biased, assumed these were contemporary comments, or made statements that did not explain why authors might reach different conclusions.

Some candidates are still not clear about the different focus of questions 3(b) and 3(c) and find they have pre-empted question 3(c). These candidates need to repeat their answer in the question 3(c) answer space and write a fresh answer to question 3(b) on separate paper.



(b) **Study Interpretations 1 and 2.**

They give different views about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923.

What is the main difference between these views?

Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations.

(4)

The main difference is the difference ~~different~~ major problem faced by the Weimar Republic. In interpretation 1, it suggests that the hyperinflation weaken the Weimar Republic. as it states, "The hyperinflation crisis had major economic effects that weaken the Weimar Republic." Whereas in Interpretation 2 it suggests that the Weimar Republic had to face rebellions from different ~~political~~ political party as it states, "the Weimar Republic had to cope with a period of extreme political difficulty."

ResultsPlus

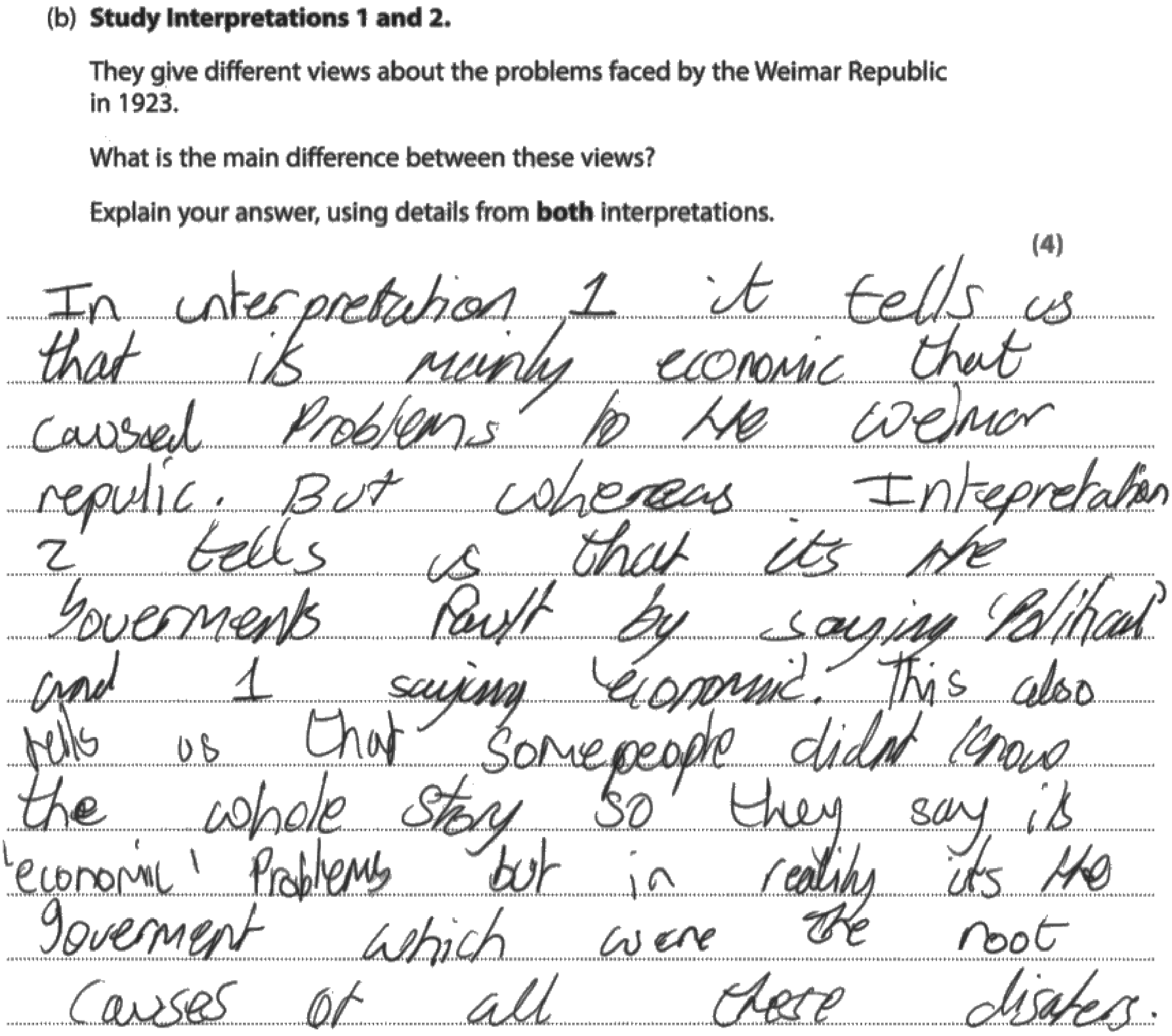
Examiner Comments

The answer identifies the difference between the interpretations very clearly, giving specific details to support the answer. It scored 4 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

A good approach is to identify the difference in the overall view and then provides details from each interpretation to support that answer.



(b) **Study Interpretations 1 and 2.**

They give different views about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923.

What is the main difference between these views?

Explain your answer, using details from **both** interpretations.

(4)

In interpretation 1 it tells us that its mainly economic that caused Problems to the weimar repulic. But whereas Interpretation 2 tells us that its the Goverments fault by saying 'Political' and 1 saying 'economic'. This also tells us that some people didnt know the whole story so they say its 'economic' Problems but in reality its the goverment which were the root causes of all these disaters.

(c) Suggest **one** reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923.

You **may** use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

(4)

one reason they may give different views is due to ~~the~~ interpretation 2 being about Political which could tell us that its could be economic and Political which both ~~work~~ be the Problem As France + belgium occupy the Ruhr the Government Prints off billions of marks to Pay back the 6.6 billion they owe but it ended up back firing cost ~~breat~~ an egg went to 80 Million Marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

The answer shows an understanding that one interpretation suggests the problems were economic while the other claims the problems were political. However, the explanation is not clear and there is little support included from the interpretations. The answer was placed in Level 1 and awarded 2 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Make sure you support your explanation with details from the interpretations.

ResultsPlus

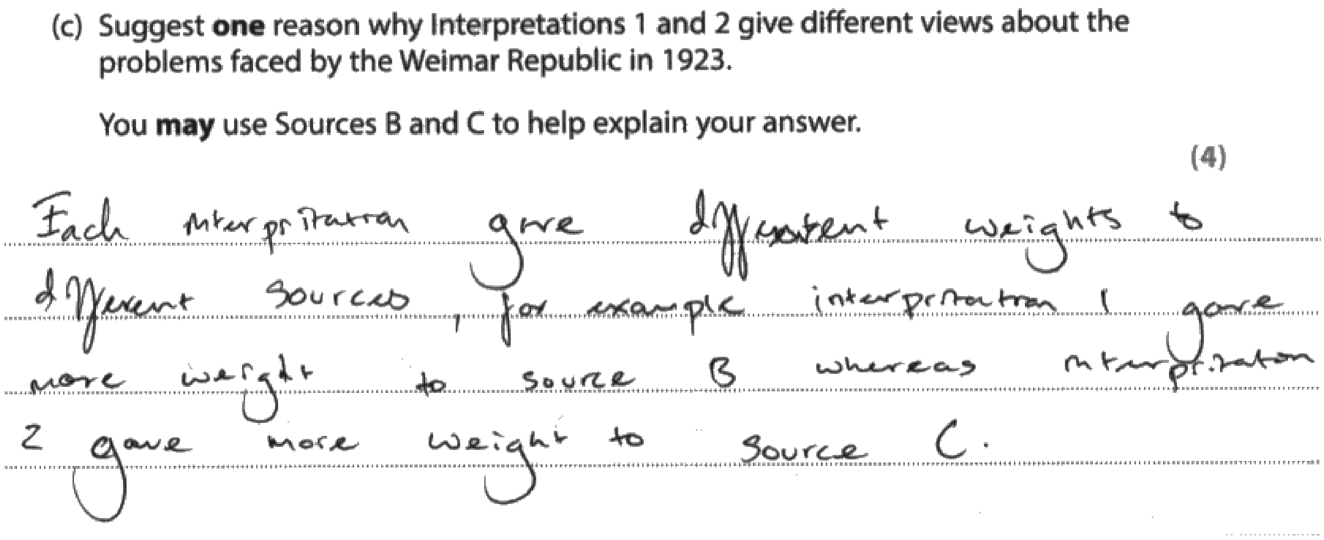
Examiner Comments

The answer to question 3(c) starts with the comment that the authors used different sources and goes on to show how the author of Interpretation 1 might have used Source B and the author of Interpretation 2 might have used Source C. This answer scored the full 4 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Make your references to the sources and interpretations clear, either by using quotations or referring to specific details.



(c) Suggest **one** reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923.

You **may** use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

(4)

Each interpritation gave different weights to different sources, for example interpretation 1 gave more weight to source B whereas interpritation 2 gave more weight to source C.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

The answer starts with the recognition that the authors may have used different sources and then shows the links between the interpretations and the sources but does not provide any details to support this. It was given 2 marks.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Remember to show how the sources fit the interpretations; don't just say that they match, use quotations or clear references to details from both the Interpretations and the sources.

Question 3(d)

Question 3(d) carries the highest number of marks on the paper. There seemed to be fewer blank answers than previously, which is particularly important as marks for Spelling, Punctuation and Grammar cannot be awarded if this answer is left blank.

Successful candidates will have already seen how the views in the interpretations are different, thought about why this might be the case and, in completing 3(a) have understood that there is likely to be evidence in support of both interpretations. They are now asked how far they agree with Interpretation 2. The strongest answers to 3(d), therefore, focused clearly on the interpretations themselves, reviewing the alternative views and coming to a substantiated judgement. Candidates need to recognise that they are not being asked to treat the interpretation as a source and evaluate its reliability or usefulness but to explain whether they think the historian has offered a convincing view.

A number of answers were trapped at the lower levels of the mark scheme because they saw this as a straightforward essay question on the problems facing the Weimar Republic. Although their comments were clearly inspired by the arguments in the interpretations, candidates offered their own views, with little or no reference to the interpretations, often prefacing their comments with phrases such as 'Some historians may think … however, some people may disagree'. Some candidates also considered a third aspect, apparently treating this as a Paper 1 or B Paper 16-mark question. This approach misses the focus of the question, which is about making a judgement on the view offered in Interpretation 2.

While the use of contextual knowledge is an important element in every level of the mark scheme, it must be precisely selected and linked to the evaluation of the interpretation rather than being offered as an answer to the enquiry question. Many lengthy answers included extensive sections of additional knowledge about hyperinflation or the Munich Putsch but lost the focus on the interpretations. In contrast, a number of successful answers were relatively concise, integrating brief details from contextual knowledge into an evaluation of the interpretations, for example, explaining the impact of hyperinflation on society, or showing that other political challenges had occurred previously. At the same time, merely asserting agreement with points in the interpretation by saying 'from my own knowledge I know this to be true' is not sufficient evidence of contextual knowledge.

At all levels of the mark scheme, answers are expected to analyse both interpretations and discuss the difference in the views being offered, so answers should be explicit in their references to the Interpretations rather than presenting this as their own knowledge. In a number of cases, details from an interpretation were presented as independent confirmation that the interpretation was accurate. The analysis of the interpretations was most successful if quotations or explicit references were included at various points rather than simply being used as an introduction or conclusion to a section. Candidates often successfully used details from Interpretation 1 to counter the view in Interpretation 2. When answers focused exclusively on the view provided in interpretation 2 and used this as a basis for an essay based on their own knowledge, they were less successful.

There is no expectation of a specific structure to answers but it may be helpful to remember that the question asks how convincing Interpretation 2 is, not which interpretation the candidate finds most convincing. As stated above, the interpretations do not need to be dealt with in equal depth but both should be examined explicitly. It is expected that candidates will reach a judgement on interpretation 2 when answering this question and the strongest candidates developed their evaluation throughout the answer, creating a consistently argued response. Less successful answers offered points to support the views expressed in interpretation 2, then used interpretation 1 and contextual knowledge to offer a different view, before reaching the judgement that interpretation 2 was ‘somewhat accurate’ or saying that they ‘partially’ agreed with the view in Interpretation 2. In these answers, there was little sense of evaluation, simply an explanation of the different views, with the acknowledgement that each had some valid points, followed by a conclusion containing an arbitrary judgement.

The strongest answers to question 3(d), therefore, focused clearly on the interpretations themselves, integrating evaluation while reviewing the alternative views and coming to a substantiated judgement. A number of answers suggested that the issues identified in the interpretations were linked, for example, economic problems contributed to political weakness, which was then evidence that the view in Interpretation 2 was incorrect, as economic issues were at the root of the problems the government faced. Alternatively, Interpretation 2’s emphasis on political issues as the most severe challenge the government faced could be confirmed, as political weakness prevented the government from dealing with hyperinflation. This approach was built on a consistent line of argument throughout the answer and an explanation of the criteria being used, which is different from an answer saying the interpretation is ‘somewhat accurate’.

Examiners reported some impressive answers to 3(d) and many candidates were able to engage confidently with the interpretations, taking a range of approaches. The focus in these answers remained on the interpretations and candidates who examined precise details from the interpretations and then used their own knowledge to support or challenge these points were more likely to gain the higher levels than those who focused on the enquiry and included extensive sections of contextual knowledge.

The existence of the strands which make up AO4 leads to ‘best-fit marking'. All strands are considered before a final mark is decided upon. The most successful candidates, therefore, were able to display evidence of meeting the demands of all three strands:

- the analysis of the provided interpretations
- the deployment of contextual knowledge to support the application of criteria
- the quality of the judgement based on reasoning and the evidence presented.

There is no automatic cap at Level 1 if an answer fails to consider both interpretations, fails to make precise references to the interpretations, or fails to use contextual knowledge, as strong performance in the other strands may lift an answer.

It was also pleasing to see there seemed to be an increased awareness that the difference in the views presented in the interpretations can be conveyed through selection/omission of detail, or emphasis, as well as through language and tone.

13:51-14:18

Spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology will be assessed in part (d).

(d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923?

Explain your answer, using **both** interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

(16)

On the one hand, you could agree with interpretation 2 that the greatest problem faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923 was political opposition. This is because interpretation 2 says 'the political crisis worsend, the government announced a state of emergency throughout Germany'. Due to a state of emergency being declared, this usually meant the use of Article 48 by the president, meaning he could rule by decree. This was only necessary due to Hitler's beer hall putsch where 'he declared the local government and the national government would be replaced'. Hitler held the local government hostage and planned to overthrow the Weimar Republic. Due to the hyperinflation crisis leading the public to support more extremist parties, Hitler would have been a powerful candidate which the public would have supported. Furthermore, the fact that a state of emergency likely resulted in the use of Article 48, shows that President Ebert was afraid ~~in~~ of Hitler's political threat. Therefore, Hitler's powerful opposition showed the Weimar Republic were subject to significant political threat. Additionally, ~~the fact that~~ the government 'had to cope' with political difficulty, ~~shows that~~ with the word 'cope' suggesting that the Weimar Republic were not in control, but rather had to struggle with political instability. Furthermore, the pessimistic tone of the article ~~shows~~ dictates that the government were powerless and relied heavily upon Article 48 and the use of the German army.

On the other hand, you could agree with interpretation 1 that it was the economic difficulties which the Weimar Republic struggled most with. This is because of the hyperinflation crisis caused when '60,000 French and Belgian troops occupied the Ruhr'. The Ruhr accounted for 40% of Germany's profit, therefore Germany lost a

Significant cause of their wealth. Furthermore, out of retaliation, ~~Ger~~ the Weimar Republic demanded the workers stop working. However, this meant they still had to pay the workers with money they no longer had. ~~This result~~ Consequently, the government had to print more money, leading to the Mark losing its value. This lost the wealth of not only the public, but the rich upper class. This meant that the Weimar Republic had lost the support of everyone. This led to people being more willing to vote extremist parties and eventually removed the power of the Weimar Republic as a whole. The fact that the government 'needed' to print money, highlights how unstable the economy was and how the Weimar Republic lacked control. Additionally, the sympathetic tone of the article dictates how the government was weak and vulnerable, viewed as something to be pitied. Therefore, the weakness of the Weimar Republic is shown through their inability to handle economic struggles and the hyperinflation crisis.

In conclusion, you could agree with interpretation two that political opposition posed the biggest threat to the Weimar Republic. This is because of powerful men such as Hitler gaining significant support and forcing the country into 'a state of emergency' which the government struggled to control. However, I believe that interpretation 1 reveals a more significant truth that financial ruin posed an even greater threat. I think this because, not only did economic problems cause the loss of support from the working class, but also from the upper class. This means that powerful men were more willing to vote extremist parties. However, as the KPD wished to share assets, these men financially supported Hitler. This means that had the Weimar Republic prevented the hyperinflation crisis, the political threat of Hitler would have never been an issue, proving hyperinflation was the greatest issue.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

From the start of the answer, there is a focus on how convincing Interpretation 2 is. Quotations from the interpretation are confirmed by contextual knowledge being used precisely, for example the reference to Article 48 is used to support the interpretation's comment about a state of emergency being declared. The answer shows excellent understanding and use of Source C in the distinction being made between local and national government. There is also some discussion of the negative tone and the language in the focus on the author's word 'cope' suggesting the government struggled with political stability.

When discussing Interpretation 1, the answer uses contextual knowledge to explain why the occupation of the Ruhr had such a significant economic impact and goes on to show how this linked to political instability as the government lacked control. The answer highlights the phrase that the government 'needed' to print additional money and comments that the sympathetic tone, showing the government as weak and vulnerable, leads to the view that the government was to be pitied.

The conclusion considers the view in Interpretation 2 but then argues strongly that the economic issues were the root of the problems facing the Weimar Republic and therefore it is less convincing than Interpretation 1.

The answer as a whole, is well-constructed, with a focus on evaluating Interpretation2 and a clear line of argument, leading to a judgement. Contextual knowledge is used precisely to support the evaluation and the candidate shows an awareness of the language and tone creating an overall impression in the two interpretations. This answer received 16 marks and 4 for spag.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Remember the question is about evaluating Interpretation 2 - keep focused on the interpretations and make precise references to them rather than writing an essay on hyperinflation and the Munich Putsch.

(d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923?

Explain your answer, using **both** interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

(16)

I partially agree with interpretation 2 as it shows that the Weimar republic faced political opposition. For example, it says "the government [illegible] of the Weimar republic had to cope with a period of extreme political difficulty". This meant that people weren't happy with ~~to~~ the Weimar republic and wanted to take [illegible] power and get rid of proportional representation and coalition governments. ~~restore of Germany to its former glory~~. This supports my own knowledge ~~of~~ that Hitler ~~occupying~~ occupied the Weimar [illegible] [illegible] republics bases of their army and police, meaning that they couldn't fight against their opposition with force and violence. Additionally, it says that "Hitler burst in with his armed SA". This meant that Hitler was keen to overthrow the current government, even ~~he~~ if he had to do so by using force and terror. However, I know from my own knowledge that Hitlers first attempt to gain power failed as General Ludendoff told the police what Hitler was planning. The next day, Hitler and the SA were intercepted. Hitler was sentenced to 5 years in prison and the NSDAP was banned.*

I agree with interpretation 1 as it shows that the Weimar republic faced economic challenges. For example, it says "the hyperinflation crisis had major economic effects that weakened the Weimar republic". This meant that, due to the economic challenges and the extreme rise in prices, ~~the Weimar republics support for~~ support for the Weimar republic deteriorated further. Thissupports my own knowledge that the middle classes were upset and aggitated as hyperinflation had caused them to lose all of their savings as their money was now worthless. Additionally, it says "60 000 French and Belgian troops occupied the Ruhr in January 1923". This meant that the German economy would further be damaged as the French were demanding money that Germany didn't have. This supports my own knowledge that ~~the~~ Germany had to pay off £6.6 billion in debt following the Treaty of Versailles, some of that money going to France and ~~Belgian~~ Belgium due to the war damage caused by WW1. However, this debt had not been fully paid off, which then led to the invasion of the Ruhr. Therefore, I agree with Interpretation 1 because it describes the events of hyperinflation and the invasion of the Ruhr, which were both events that damaged Germanys economy.

* Therefore, I only partially agree with interpretation 2 because there was political opposition from the NSDAP but they were intercepted before they gained any ~~gott~~ real power over Germany in [illegible] 1923.

Overall I agree with Interpretation 1 as the economic challenges in Germany had a larger effect on the ~~econ~~ Republic than the political opposition in 1923.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

The answer selects details from Interpretation 2 and comments on them, using contextual knowledge to confirm the Interpretation. It then comments on details in Interpretation 1, again using contextual knowledge to support the comments and to show how hyperinflation affected various different groups. A judgement is stated, making a good point about the 'layer' effect of hyperinflation but with limited explanation of its significance in relation to Interpretation 2.
The answer was placed in Level 3 and given 12 marks, with 3 for spag,as it reviewed both interpretations and used contextual knowledge, before offering a judgement. There is a sense of each interpretation being evaluated individually but the answer does not have a consistent line of reasoning about Interpretation 2.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Try to develop an overall line of reasoning that evaluates Interpretation 2 rather than writing about each interpretation in turn.

(d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923?

Explain your answer, using **both** interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

(16)

I disagree fully with Interpretation 2 ~~about~~ that the most threatening problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923 were political. For example, ~~fa~~ the historian in Interpretation 2 says "the Weimar Republic had to ~~deal~~ cope with a period of extreme political difficulty." I Know that during 1923, Hitler led the Munich Putsch with the aim of gaining power. ~~For~~ Hitler had decided to launch a putsch where him and his SA would march into Munich and rally support. He then, with the help of war-hero Ludendorff, held local government leaders captive in a beer hall where they were meeting. However, Hitler failed to gain enough support and was ultimately outnumbered by the police and army. The police ~~also~~ were also ~~had been told~~ warned about the putsch by Von Kahr, a ~~governm~~ government official, who was let go by Ludendorff on the promise that he wouldn't alert the authorities about ~~to~~ Hitler's plans. It ended with Hitler being arrested and imprisoned. Although, the Munich was a serious problem faced ~~by the~~ by the Weimar Republic in 1923, it wasn't the most threatening problem because it was shut down quickly.

Conversly, I fully agree with Interpretation 1 that the most threatening problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923 were economical problems. For example, the historian in Interpretation 1 says "hyperinflation crisis had major economic effects that weakened the Weimar Republic". I agree with this because I know that in 1923 Germany had failed to pay their annual reparations on time. These reparations of £6.6 billion were decided under the Treaty of Versailles ~~after~~ in 1919 after Germany and the allies signed the armistice to end the first World War. Because Germany had failed to pay these reparations, France invaded the Ruhr until Germany payed them. In retaliation, the Weimar Government ordered the workers in the Ruhr to strike but these workers had to be payed. In order to pay these workers, the Weimar Government printed off more money. This resulted in prices increasing. For example, a piece of bread was 200,000 marks. The middle class suffered the most because their savings became worthless. Money became worthless and poverty increased. This was the most threatening problem for the Weimar Republic in 1923 because it made the Weimar Government very unpopular and appear weak.

Overall, I think hyperinflation was the most threatening problem faced by the Weimar Government because it led to other issues like the invasion of the Ruhr and even the Munich Putsch so, therefore, I disagree with Interpretation 2.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

The answer has understood the thrust of each interpretation's argument and uses contextual knowledge to consider it carefully. The judgement makes a strong argument. However, apart from a single quotation from each interpretation, there is no reference to their content.
This answer was given 9 marks, with 3 for spag.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Remember to link contextual knowledge to quotations or clear references to the content of the interpretations, rather than developing an answer based completely on own knowledge.

Paper Summary

Examiners commented that there were a number of impressive answers where candidates seemed well-prepared and demonstrated excellent knowledge being deployed to support thoughtful analysis and evaluation. However, some answers showed confusion when it seemed the candidates thought the Weimar Republic and Germany were 2 separate countries. Also, there is always confusion between the hyperinflation of 1923 in question 3 and the Depression in question 2b.

The following points should be noted:

· While there was good knowledge of some topics, candidates cannot rely on knowing just a few key topics and hoping to use that information whatever question is asked.

· Candidates need to recognise the specific focus of the question so that the information being offered is shaped to meet the demands of the question rather than simply describing a situation or including irrelevant material.

· Candidates should appreciate the difference between sources and interpretations and be aware that interpretations are constructed by historians in order to offer their view of events, based on their research.

· In all parts of Question 3, it is helpful to be explicit about the source or interpretation being discussed, especially as many candidates mislabel the sources used in question 3 as sources A and B, or mix up sources and interpretations.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar were broadly accurate and many answers used specialist terms with confidence but a poor standard of handwriting made a number of answers difficult to mark and exacerbated the difficulty in understanding a badly-expressed answer.

The SPaGST marks may be affected if there are weaknesses in these areas:

· Appropriate use of capital letters

· Correct use of apostrophes

· Weak grammar ('would of') and casual language, which is not appropriate in an examination

· Paragraphs: failure to structure answers in paragraphs not only affects the SPaGST mark, but may also make it difficult for the examiner to identify different sections of an answer.

If extra paper is taken, candidates should state clearly in the answer space for the question that it has been continued elsewhere, stating clearly where the rest of the answer had been written; this should be on an additional sheet rather than elsewhere in the answer booklet and should be clearly labelled. However, in many cases where additional paper had been taken, the marks had already been attained within the space provided rather than on the extra paper and candidates should be discouraged from assuming that lengthy answers will automatically score highly. Indeed, candidates taking extra paper sometimes ran out of time on the final, high mark question and therefore disadvantaged themselves.

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